

Introduction to RDM

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Contents

1 Data Management Planning 3

#Introduction

What is **research data**? Research data are measurements, recordings, records, or observations about the world collected by researchers with minimal contextual interpretation. They can show up in just about any format. Numbers, notes, images, films, designs, algorithms, and diagrams can all be research data. The takeaway? Research data isn't the exclusive purview of bench scientists - anyone who's engaged in the research process is a collector of, and manager of, research data.

Research Data Management describe the collective process of structuring, organizing, maintaining, and caring for research data. It's straight forward (but not always easy!) steps like:

- creating a readme file
- implementing a file naming strategy
- backing up your work

Done consistently, and done well, RDM prevents data loss, helps ensure our work has long-term value and allows for the possibility of collaboration and sharing.

Chapter 1

Data Management Planning

Why plan? Beyond all the benefits a good plan provides a research team, some funders require it.

- Tri-Agency Research Data Management Policy, Released March 15, 2021.
- Tri-Agency Statement of Principles on Digital Data Management, Released June 15, 2016.
- Tri-Agency Open Access Policy on Publications, Last modified December 21, 2016.
- Access to Research Results: Guiding Principles